

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate effective communication skills by arranging, organizing, and presenting information orally without prior knowledge of the topic. The speech may serve one or more purposes: to impress, to inform, or to persuade. Any postsecondary division contestant may enter this judged event. The event may be repeated.

Contestant Must Supply

- Sharpened pencils, pens

Equipment/Supplies Provided

- Three (3) notecards per contestant
- Topics

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes preparation, no less than three (3) and no more than five (5) minutes speech
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Contest Competencies

1. Demonstrate clear, professional, and effective oral communication when presenting ideas
2. Organize the speech using a clear introduction, body, and conclusion to create a coherent message
3. Use appropriate tempo, pitch, and vocal variety to enhance clarity and audience engagement
4. Use purposeful nonverbal gestures, posture, and eye contact to support confident delivery
5. Analyze the assigned topic quickly and develop key points supported by logical reasoning, examples, and relevant business insights
6. Adapt tone, language, and delivery to meet audience expectations
7. Use effective opening and closing statements to strengthen the overall message
8. Demonstrate professionalism, confidence, and ethical communication while presenting under pressure

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The contestant will draw two (2) different business topics and will select either one. The topics may deal with Business Professionals of America, office situations, the business world, etc.
- The event proctor will provide three (3) notecards. Notes can only be made on the notecards provided.
- No advisor contact will be allowed between the time of receiving the topic and the delivery
- No materials or previously prepared notes will be allowed into the preparation or presentation room with the contestant
- No personal electronic devices (smart watches, smart glasses, cell phone, etc.)
- The contestant will be given warnings via flash cards when there are two (2) minutes remaining and when there is (1) minute remaining during the speaking time

740 Contemporary Issues

Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
If no to the question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-7 points	Meets Expectations 8-14 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Contestant rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Speaker occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Speaker maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/20
Organization, Design & Structure	The speech lacks coherence and structure, making it unclear and difficult to follow. Transitions between points are awkward or absent.	The speech content has some gaps, making it not always clear and somewhat difficult to follow. Transitions between points are choppy.	The speech content flows adequately, with a mostly clear structure and smooth transitions between points.	/20
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-30 points	Above Expectations 31-50 points	Points Awarded
Effectiveness	The speech demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic or prompt, often veering into irrelevant or off-topic information. The purpose of the speech (to decide, to impress, to inform, to persuade) is not achieved or unclear.	The speech addresses the general topic or prompt but lacks depth and specific focus. The purpose of the speech is partially achieved but lacks clear effectiveness in decision-making, impressing, informing, or persuading.	The speech comprehensively addresses the topic with a clear and focused approach. It includes relevant information that directly relates to the context given. The purpose of the speech (to decide, to impress, to inform, to persuade) is effectively achieved with clarity and impact.	/50
Timing & Documentation	The speech lasted no less than three (3) minutes and no more than five (5) minutes and the contestant did <i>not</i> use any materials other than those specified.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

SPEECH WILL BE STOPPED AT FIVE (5) MINUTES